PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Jeep Wrangler JL

2018–present · JL

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Run the VIN for recalls before anything else**
  JL recalls include the 2018–2019 track-bar bracket weld (18V-675), the manual-clutch pressure plate (20V-124, 21V-028 and 23V-116), the 2018 transmission park-lock rod (18V-280) and cruise-control software (18V-332) campaigns, and the 2021–2025 power-steering pump wiring fire risk (26V-363). Make sure they've all been done.
- [ ] **Feel the steering at highway speed**
  Vague, light or wandering steering on a 2018–2020 truck points to the early aluminum steering box (owners cite TSB 08-074-20). A shake after bumps points to the damper, track bar or worn front-end parts.
- [ ] **Look at the track-bar welds**
  ExtremeTerrain warns 2018 owners to be 'mindful of the track bar to body weld.' Check both track-bar brackets for cracks and the frame welds for poor penetration, which is what owners complained about to NHTSA.
- [ ] **Manual trucks: clutch history**
  Ask whether the clutch recall was done, test for slip in a high gear at low revs, and smell for a cooked clutch after a short climb.
- [ ] **Peek at the valley on a 3.6**
  Oil weeping at the back of the engine, under the intake, means the oil cooler/filter housing is going.
- [ ] **2.0T: coolant level and plug receipts**
  Check the coolant bottle and turbo lines for leaks, and ask for proof of the 30,000-mile spark plug changes the factory schedule calls for.
- [ ] **eTorque: listen for start-stop faults**
  Pickup Truck + SUV Talk lists early auxiliary-battery failures as a known JL issue, with flickering dash lights and random warnings.
- [ ] **Decide whether you need the 2024 refresh**
  The 2024 update brought side-curtain airbags, the 12.3-inch screen and the full-float rear axle option. A 2018–2023 truck with its fixes done is the value buy.

YEARS TO KNOW

2018	BEWARE	JL launch (four-door production from November 2017, two-door from early 2018): 3.6 Pentastar with a 6-speed manual or 8-speed auto, plus a 2.0 turbo with eTorque (auto only). The year to be wary of: NHTSA recalls cover track-bar bracket welds (18V-675), the intermediate steering shaft weld (18V-343) and rear frame-rail corrosion (18V-231), manual trucks are in the clutch recalls, and SlashGear counts more than 1,000 owner complaints, mostly highway wander. Buy one only with every fix documented

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Front track bar bracket welds (the 'frame weld' recall)**
  2018–2019 · NHTSA 18V-675
- ☐ **Intermediate steering shaft weld**
  2018 · NHTSA 18V-343
- ☐ **Rear underbody ladder rail corrosion**
  2018 · NHTSA 18V-231
- ☐ **Steering column stub shaft**
  2019 · NHTSA 19V-201
- ☐ **Manual-transmission clutch pressure plate**
  2018–2020 · NHTSA 20V-124
- ☐ **Clutch overheating software**
  2018–2021 · NHTSA 21V-028
- ☐ **Clutch assembly replacement**
  2018–2023 · NHTSA 23V-116
- ☐ **Left lower control arm bracket weld**
  2020 · NHTSA 20V-042
- ☐ **Frame stud can puncture fuel tank**
  2020–2022 · NHTSA 23V-191
- ☐ **Instrument cluster short**
  2018–2024 · NHTSA 24V-652

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Real Rubicon**
  Dana M210 (44-class) front and M220 rear with Tru-Lok electronic lockers, Rock-Trac with 4:1 low range, and an electronic sway-bar disconnect. Sport and Sahara have the M186 ('Dana 30') front and M200 ('Dana 35') rear, with an optional limited slip, and Command-Trac with 2.72:1 (Selec-Trac optional on Sahara).
- ☐ **Factory 35s**
  Factory Xtreme 35 trucks (2.0T two-door Rubicon and Willys from 2024; standard on the 2.0T two-door Rubicon X) have LT315/70R17 BFGoodrich KO2s on 17×8 beadlock-capable wheels, 4.56 gears, a 1.5 in lift and a reinforced swing gate.
- ☐ **Engine**
  The 3.6 Pentastar comes with the 6-speed manual or 8-speed auto. The 2.0 turbo is auto-only. There was never a two-door 4xe, 392 or EcoDiesel.
- ☐ **Pre- or post-facelift**
  2024-on trucks have the 12-inch Uconnect 5 screen with horizontal dash vents. All but Sport and Sport S also get the new grille.
- ☐ **JL vs JK at a glance**
  The JL's headlights cut into the grille, the spare sits lower and the Jeep logo is no longer on the grille.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/jeep/jl/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks